

Setting up the robot took only a few minutes. As expected, you'll need a 2.4GHz Wi-Fi connection, and the first mapping run is mandatory before you can start using room-specific features. The mapping process itself was quick and accurate, and I didn't face any problems during setup.

Post that, I was mainly using the vacuum cleaner to clean by rooms and rarely by zones. Within the Dreamehome app, you get customisation options for room-specific cleaning routines, schedules, suction levels and virtual boundaries.

The Dreamehome app is feature-rich. On the home screen, you can see the current battery and operation status, the camera feed option, and quick commands to start cleaning, charging, etc.

Most other features are tucked away under different menus. So, the interface looks clean, and only when you dig deeper will you explore the many customisation options and other settings. If it feels overwhelming, you can use shortcuts for personalised cleaning based on your preferences or widgets on your phone's homescreen. Also, while comparing the L50S Pro Ultra with a competitor, I found Dreamehome's UI isn't the fastest. So, the widgets and shortcuts can come in handy.

Smart robot with a camera

The L50S Pro Ultra navigates around the house with very little hesitation. Thanks to its combination of LiDAR, AI-powered obstacle recognition and a front-facing camera, it avoids objects on its path, mostly. During testing, it correctly recognised a polypropylene carton strap and ignored it, while another robot vacuum tried to suck it in. It also successfully avoided a loose cable piece that another competing robot vacuum swallowed completely.

The Dreame L50S Pro Ultra is also equipped with a camera that is more useful than I expected. Being able



to check on the house while away is surprisingly reassuring remotely. If you have pets, the feature becomes even more useful because you can locate them through the app, view a live feed and even interact with them remotely. It's not something you'll use every day, but when you do, you'll be glad it's there.

Thanks to the EasyLeap Obstacle Crossing, the robo wheels can let it climb small elevations of up to 40mm.

But it isn't as smart as an adult human, and also, its confident movements can sometimes seem too hasty. One example is when it is done with the cleaning, it usually moves quickly back to the dock, and during this, we saw it bumping into some corners. Even though the brand claims the L50S Pro Ultra can detect over 220 obstacle types, we suggest you don't keep delicate objects on its path.

Another thing worth noting is that if you change the base station's location, the robo cleaner will lose its way back home. Even if the dock is kept closer to it, it will seem clueless. This is with all the sensors and the RGB camera in place. It is by design meant to follow the map it has of the floor area. If you decide to change the dock's location, you are advised to map the place again before starting cleaning.

So long as the dock is at the mapped place and there aren't many obstacles on its path, the L50S Pro Ultra quietly does its job and lets you get on with yours.

In case you are concerned about privacy, note that camera access can be

locked behind a password. And if you don't want it at all, you can turn the live camera off within the settings. We have asked the brand how it processes the data collected.

One feature I did miss was regional language voice prompts. For those who are not comfortable with English, local language support would make the robot more approachable.

Verdict

A premium robot vacuum cleaner like the Dreame L50S Pro Ultra primarily offers features that offer convenience and save your time. It strictly follows the commands, navigates around obstacles more confidently, quietly gets on with its job and automatically takes care of cleaning itself on the dock. Even features like the video camera are useful for pet monitoring or simple, real-time, two-way audio communication.

The Dreame vacuum cleaner isn't perfect. Sticky stains still require multiple rounds of cleaning. You'll also want to keep cables and delicate objects off the floor. Since it is a machine designed to follow commands and patterns, obstacles can interrupt its cleaning process. The Dreamehome app offers extensive customisation, but it isn't the fastest, and support for regional language voice prompts would have made the experience more accessible.

At Rs 79999, the L50S Pro Ultra strikes a sensible balance between everyday cleaning, thoughtful automation and a polished software experience. If you're buying your first premium robot vacuum, it's worth shortlisting. And if you're upgrading, you can expect slightly better cleaning, but more importantly, a refined, quieter and largely hands-off ownership experience. **d**

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